

Table 2: An overview of Nginx and Microsoft IIS web servers

Feature	Nginx	Microsoft IIS
Architecture	Event-driven and asynchronous, efficient for handling large numbers of concurrent connections	Modular architecture integrates with other Microsoft technologies
Performance	High performance and scalability	Efficient performance, especially with Windows and ASP.NET integration
Use cases	Rate limiting, access control, SSL/TLS termination	Request filtering, IP address and domain restrictions, integrated Windows authentication
Configuration	Regular updates required for security patches and performance enhancements	Regular updates for security and compatibility with Windows and ASP.NET
Community support	Strong community support with extensive documentation and community forums	Strong support from Microsoft with resources, forums, and documentation

SSLCertificateKeyFile /path/to/private.key

Limit HTTP methods: Use the *Limit* directive to restrict the HTTP methods that are allowed for a particular directory or URL.

```
<Directory /path/to/directory>
  <LimitExcept GET POST>
    Require all denied
  </LimitExcept>
</Directory>
```

Additional security measures

Using additional security measures can further enhance the overall security of your server.

mod_security: mod_security is an Apache module that provides a web application firewall (WAF) to protect against various attacks, such as SQL injection and cross-site scripting (XSS).

```
# Enable mod_security
LoadModule security2_module modules/mod_security2.so
```

```
# Include mod_security configuration
Include conf/modsecurity.d/*.conf
```

mod_evasive: mod_evasive is an Apache module that provides protection against distributed denial of service (DDoS) attacks and brute force attacks by limiting the number of requests from

a single IP address.

```
# Enable mod_evasive
LoadModule evasive20_module modules/mod_evasive20.so
```

```
# Configure mod_evasive
DOSHashTableSize 3097
DOSPageCount 2
DOSSiteCount 50
DOSPageInterval 1
DOSSiteInterval 1
DOSBlockingPeriod 10
```

Securing other web servers

Apart from Apache, other popular web servers include Nginx and Microsoft IIS (Internet Information Services). Though MS IIS is not an open source-based web server, it still needs a mention as it is a widely used web server. Table 2 gives a brief overview of each.

Here are a few common security practices applicable to all web servers.

- **Regular updates:** Keep the web server software, operating system, and other components up to date with the latest security patches and updates.

- **Secure configuration:** Configure the web server securely, following best practices and disabling unnecessary features and services.
- **Strong authentication:** Use strong authentication mechanisms, such as multi-factor authentication (MFA), to protect access to the server.
- **Secure communication:** Use SSL/TLS certificates to encrypt data transmitted between clients and the server.
- **Access control:** Implement strict access control measures to ensure that only authorised users and processes have access to the server and its resources.
- **Logging and monitoring:** Enable logging and monitoring to detect and respond to security incidents promptly.

Securing Apache and other web servers is essential. By adopting best practices and smart strategies, organisations can shield their servers from cyber threats, ensuring their online services remain safe and reliable. Continuous improvement and vigilance are key in this ever-evolving landscape. **END** 🐧

By: Dhaval Gajjar

The author is the CTO of Textdrip, and the CEO of Pranshtech Solutions and WeTechnolabs Solutions. With a passion for technology and innovation, he explores the ever-evolving world of digital solutions, sharing insights and expertise to drive progress in the tech industry.